

Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–1995

Teacher Answer Key



Conflict in the Middle East

Key Enquiry Questions

- Lesson 1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949
- Lesson 2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War
- Lesson 3: Increased Tension, 1955–1963
- Lesson 4: The Six Day War, 1967
- Lesson 5: The Aftermath of the 1967 War

- Lesson 6: Israel and Egypt, 1967–1973
- Lesson 7: Diplomatic negotiations, 1974–1979
- Lesson 8: The Palestinian Issue, 1974–1993
- Lesson 9: Attempts at a solution, 1988–1995

Name:

Class:

Lesson 1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

Q1. What impact did the King David Hotel bombing have on the British Mandate?

Source A: The Ruins of the King David Hotel, 1946



The southern wing of the King David Hotel in Jerusalem following the Irgun bomb attack on 22 July 1946.

Vocabulary Focus

Task: Fill in the blanks in the summary below using the correct words from the word bank.

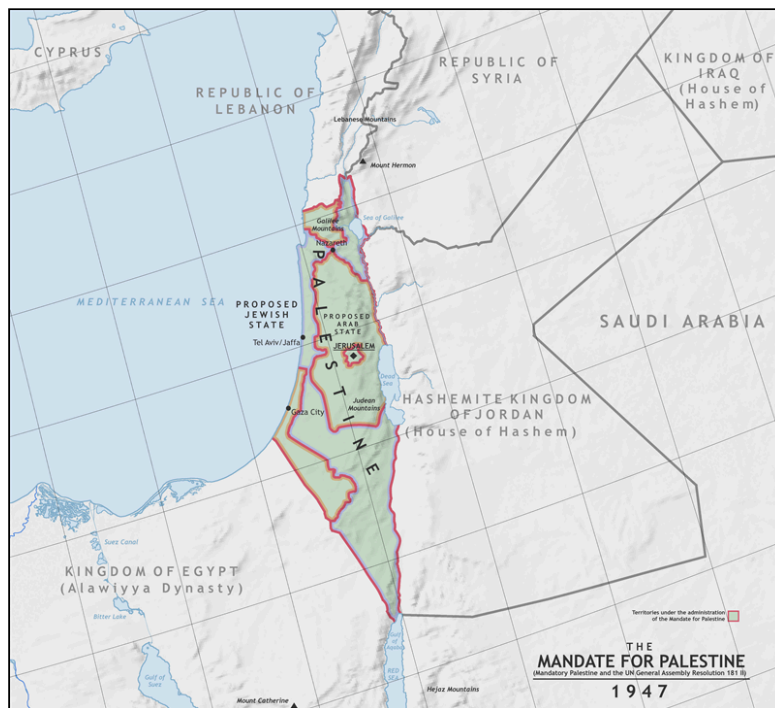
Word Bank: Mandate | Zionism | Irgun | Nakba

Following World War II, Britain struggled to control its League of Nations

_____ in Palestine. The horrors of the Holocaust increased

international sympathy for _____, leading to demands for a Jewish state. As tensions rose, militant groups like the _____ launched violent attacks against the British, such as the bombing of the King David Hotel. Ultimately, the 1948 war resulted in the creation of Israel but also led to the _____, where hundreds of thousands of Palestinians were displaced.

Reference Map: UN Partition Plan (Resolution 181)



Map of the UN Partition Plan of 1947 allocating 55% to the Jewish State and 45% to the Arab State.

The Decisive Factor in Israel's Victory

GCSE examiners award top marks to students who can analyze how multiple, interrelated factors combined to produce the war's final outcome. Israel's victory was not a miracle, but rather the result of distinct military, political, and structural advantages.

The Arab coalition was plagued by deep political rivalries and conflicting territorial ambitions. For example, King Abdullah of Transjordan was primarily interested in annexing the West Bank

for his own kingdom, rather than destroying Israel. Although facing a combined Arab population of 41 million, the 650,000 Jews of Israel mobilized their entire society. At the war's start, Israel's combat forces stood at 35,000 (already larger than the active invasion force). By December 1948, the IDF grew to a highly coordinated force of 108,000 troops, vastly outnumbering the fragmented Arab armies.

Q2. Evaluate why Israel was able to win the 1948-49 Arab-Israeli War despite being surrounded by five invading Arab nations.

Israel won due to superior organization, unified leadership, and critical material support. While the Arab states were deeply divided by political rivalries and failed to commit their full military strength, Israel mobilized its entire society, creating a unified IDF command. The crucial one-month UN truce allowed Israel to import modern Czech weapons, overturning the initial military imbalance and allowing a highly motivated force to outnumber and defeat the fragmented Arab coalition.

Historian's Corner: The Debate over Plan Dalet

Historians sharply disagree on the nature of Plan D. Traditional Israeli historians argue it was a purely defensive necessity to secure besieged Jewish settlements before the Arab armies invaded. However, 'New Historians' like Ilan Pappé argue the text of Plan D proves it was a deliberate blueprint for the systematic ethnic cleansing of Palestinian Arabs from the future Jewish state.

GCSE Cross-Source Analysis

How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into Write a narrative account analysing the key events of 1945–48 which led to the creation of Israel. (8 marks)?

“We must use terror, assassination, intimidation, land confiscation, and the cutting of all social services to rid the Galilee of its Arab population.”

Source A: A quote often attributed to a Zionist commander, reflecting the offensive view of Plan D.

“The objective of this plan is the control of the area of the Jewish State and the defense of its borders... against the enemy.”

Source B: An extract from the official text of Plan Dalet, March 1948.

Source Evaluation Notes

Source	N.O.P. (Nature, Origin, Purpose)	Content (What it shows/says)	Contextual Knowledge
A			
B			

Final Written Evaluation

Lesson 2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War

Vocabulary Focus

Task: Read the key terms and their definitions. Choose **two** terms and write a single, historically accurate sentence that connects them.

Green Line: The 1949 armistice borders drawn in green ink, giving Israel 79% of mandate Palestine.

UNRWA: United Nations agency created in 1949 to provide relief for Palestinian refugees.

Law of Return: 1950 Israeli law granting any Jew the right to immigrate to Israel and receive automatic citizenship.

Fedayeen: Palestinian guerrilla fighters who launched cross-border raids into Israel from the Gaza Strip.

Lesson 3: Increased Tension, 1955–1963

Vocabulary Focus

Task: Complete the Frayer Models for the key concepts below. Write the definition, one historical example, and one non-example (or a sketch).

Concept: Pan-Arabism

Definition: A political movement aimed at uniting all Arab nations to throw off Western colonial influence and secure Arab independence.	Historical Example:
Characteristics:	Non-example / Sketch:

Concept: Czech Arms Deal

Definition: A 1955 agreement where the Soviet bloc supplied Egypt with massive amounts of advanced weaponry, shocking the West.	Historical Example:
Characteristics:	Non-example / Sketch:

Lesson 4: The Six Day War, 1967

Vocabulary Focus

Task: Fill in the blanks in the summary below using the correct words from the word bank.

Word Bank: PLO (Palestine Liberation Organisation) | Fatah | Pre-emptive Strike | Casus Belli

In the 1960s, Palestinian nationalism grew stronger with the creation of the _____, an umbrella organization, and its dominant guerrilla faction, _____. Border tensions flared violently when Israel launched the _____ into the West Bank in 1966. These escalating events eventually culminated in June 1967 when Israel launched _____, a devastating pre-emptive air strike that wiped out the Arab air forces on the ground.

Lesson 5: The Aftermath of the 1967 War

Vocabulary Focus

Task: Read the key terms and their definitions. Choose **two** terms and write a single, historically accurate sentence that connects them.

UN Resolution 242: A UN Security Council resolution adopted in 1967 calling for 'land for peace' and Israeli withdrawal from occupied territories.

Khartoum Resolution: An August 1967 Arab League agreement issuing the 'Three Nos': no peace, no recognition, and no negotiations with Israel.

PFLP: The Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine, a radical Marxist splinter group that pioneered international aviation terrorism.

Black September: A 1970 civil war where Jordan's King Hussein crushed the PLO; also the name of the secretive PLO faction responsible for the Munich Olympics massacre.

Operation Wrath of God: A highly secretive, global assassination campaign launched by the Israeli Mossad to hunt down the planners of the Munich Olympics massacre.

Lesson 6: Israel and Egypt, 1967–1973

Vocabulary Focus

Task: Complete the Frayer Models for the key concepts below. Write the definition, one historical example, and one non-example (or a sketch).

Concept: War of Attrition

Definition: A grinding border conflict (1969-1970) where Nasser used continuous artillery fire and raids to wear down Israel along the Suez Canal.	Historical Example:
Characteristics:	Non-example / Sketch:

Concept: SAM-3 Missiles

Definition: Advanced Soviet surface-to-air missiles installed along the Suez Canal to shoot down Israeli fighter jets.	Historical Example:
Characteristics:	Non-example / Sketch:

Lesson 7: Diplomatic negotiations, 1974–1979

Vocabulary Focus

Task: Fill in the blanks in the summary below using the correct words from the word bank.

Word Bank: OPEC | Shuttle Diplomacy | Likud | Camp David Accords |
Treaty of Washington

Lesson 8: The Palestinian Issue, 1974–1993

Vocabulary Focus

Task: Read the key terms and their definitions. Choose **two** terms and write a single, historically accurate sentence that connects them.

UN Resolution 3236: A 1974 UN resolution that recognized the inalienable rights of the Palestinian people to self-determination and granted the PLO observer status.

Fatahland: The PLO's powerful 'state-within-a-state' in southern Lebanon, from which they launched rocket attacks into northern Israel.

Operation Peace for Galilee: The 1982 full-scale Israeli military invasion of Lebanon aimed at destroying the PLO's infrastructure.

Sabra and Shatila: Two Palestinian refugee camps in Beirut where Phalangist militias massacred hundreds of civilians in 1982 while the IDF held the perimeter.

First Intifada: A grassroots, popular civilian uprising ('The Shaking Off') against Israeli occupation that erupted in Gaza and the West Bank in 1987.

Hezbollah: A radical Shia militant movement ('The Party of God') backed by Iran that emerged in Lebanon following the PLO's expulsion.

Lesson 9: Attempts at a solution, 1988–1995

Vocabulary Focus

Task: Complete the Frayer Models for the key concepts below. Write the definition, one historical example, and one non-example (or a sketch).

Concept: UNLU

Definition: Unified National Leadership of the Uprising; grassroots local committees that coordinated the First Intifada on the ground.	Historical Example:
Characteristics:	Non-example / Sketch:

Concept: Two-state solution

Definition: A diplomatic framework proposing an independent State of Palestine alongside the State of Israel.	Historical Example:
Characteristics:	Non-example / Sketch: